

Sebastian Reed

ACT I / Before the murder

Your history with Sterling

You found an archival document that contradicted the Star Bowl label. Sterling told your department your fellowship could disappear if you pushed it.

What you are hiding

You have not yet told Marcus that your discovery also undermines one sentence in his published research. Do not volunteer this immediately. In Act II, protect it unless interrogation forces your hand; in Act III, reveal it if you need to defend yourself.

Your objectives

- Protect your private complication until you decide disclosure helps you.
- Use your public relationships to trade information rather than waiting for clues to come to you.
- Ask at least two people where they were during the poisoning window.

What you know about other guests

- Celeste commissioned independent provenance work outside the normal chain of approval.
- You found a source that complicates one published claim by your adviser Marcus.

Notes / Who will you speak to first?

ACT II / After Sterling dies

Follow your assigned branch. Keep it private. If you are the murderer, the innocent branch is a cover story you may claim.

IF INNOCENT

Celeste was reviewing the disputed label with you during the entire critical window.

IF MURDERER

You used your student access badge to enter at 6:47, poisoned the cordial, and dropped an archival tab from your notes.

ACT III / Evidence update

Your sealed evidence pair contains Cards A and B. If you are INNOCENT, secretly submit Card B. If you are the MURDERER, secretly submit Card A. Put the unused card away.

FINAL STATEMENT / Read only if called

IF INNOCENT

I found a document that complicates one of Marcus's published claims, and I had not yet told him. Sterling threatened my fellowship if I pushed the discovery. That is terrifying when you are twenty-four, but Celeste was reviewing the evidence with me throughout the poisoning window.

IF MURDERER

Sterling told me the truth could wait until I was no longer funded enough to find it. I used my access badge, went into the salon, poisoned his cordial, and dropped an archival tab from the very document he wanted buried. I wanted to prove I belonged in this field. This is not how.

Investigation notes
